

Benefits Overview

This overview summarises the benefits that Northwind Labs offers to employees in 2026. Exact terms depend on your country of employment and are set out in your contract and in the plan documents in Workday under "Benefits". Questions go to the People team in Slack #people-help.

Individual pay and compensation are not covered here. Your compensation is described in your offer letter and in Workday.

1. Enrolment

You enrol in benefits in Workday during your first week (the "Benefits enrolment" task). If you miss the 30-day enrolment window you can join at the next open enrolment period, which runs from **1 to 30 November** each year, unless you have a qualifying life event such as marriage or the birth of a child.

2. Health insurance

Country	Provider	Who is covered
Portugal	Médis	Employee, partner and children; dental included
Germany	Statutory insurance plus Ottonova supplementary plan	Employee; supplementary dental and vision
Poland	LUX MED (premium package)	Employee, partner and children
United States	Aetna (PPO and HSA plans), Delta Dental, VSP vision	Employee, spouse or domestic partner and children
Remote employees elsewhere	Local plan via our employer-of-record partner, Deel	As defined by the local plan

Northwind pays the full premium for employees and the majority of the premium for dependants. Coverage starts on your first day of employment.

3. Life and disability insurance

All employees are covered by group life insurance and long-term disability insurance from day one, at no cost to the employee. You can name or change your beneficiaries in Workday at any time.

4. Retirement plans

- **Portugal, Germany and Poland:** a company pension plan is offered on top of the state system, with an employer contribution. Poland employees are automatically enrolled in the PPK scheme and may opt out.
- **United States:** a 401(k) plan with Fidelity, including an employer match. You can enrol from your first payroll.

Contribution details are in the plan documents in Workday.

5. Wellbeing

- **Employee Assistance Programme (EAP):** free, confidential counselling for you and your family through Lyra Health, available 24/7 in English, Portuguese, German and Polish. Up to 8 sessions per issue per year.
- **Mental health app:** a free Headspace subscription for every employee.
- **Wellbeing days:** two extra paid days off per year, called "Recharge Days", that the whole company takes together. In 2026 they are 22 May and 13 November.
- **Ergonomic assessment:** every office-based employee can book a free ergonomic assessment with the office manager.

6. Time off and family

- Vacation allowance, sick leave and other leave types are described in the Time Off and Leave Policy (POL-HR-002).
- Parental leave is described in the Parental Leave Summary.
- Public holidays per office are listed in the Holidays Calendar 2026.

7. Learning and development

Every employee has a personal annual learning budget for courses, books and conferences. See the Learning Budget page for the amount and how to use it.

8. Equipment and remote work

- Every employee receives a laptop and accessories; see the IT Setup Guide.
- Fully remote employees can claim a one-time home office equipment allowance; remote and hybrid employees can claim a monthly home internet allowance. Limits are in the Expense Policy (POL-FIN-001).

9. Other perks

Perk	Details
Lunch	Free team lunch on anchor days (Tuesday and Thursday) in every office
Commuting	Public transport passes are paid in Lisbon, Berlin and Kraków; Austin employees get validated garage parking
Bike leasing	JobRad bike leasing in Germany
Referral programme	A referral reward for every hire you refer, paid after the new hire's 90th day
Northwind Day	The office closes on 18 September to celebrate our anniversary

10. Changes to benefits

Northwind reviews benefits every year in October. Changes are announced in #announcements and take effect on 1 January. This overview was last updated on 5 January 2026.